

ACE OF CARDS

ALSO: Deckmancer, Destiny Duelist, High Roller



*In response,
I activate my
hidden card!*

Aces of Cards make use of special decks to perceive the constant fluctuations in the stream of souls. Each deck is inextricably connected to its user and reflects their taste and personality. By drawing specific combinations at the right moment, an Ace of Cards manipulates magical energy to produce supernatural effects.

In some worlds, Aces of Cards duel against each other using their personal decks, in a quest for glory or in order to obtain precious artifacts.

- ♦ When did you first manifest your magic powers?
- ♦ Are you cold and perceptive, or brash and lively? What does your deck look like?
- ♦ What was the most unfortunate event in your life? What did you learn from it?
- ♦ How do you combine your deck with your other abilities?



ACE OF CARDS FREE BENEFITS

- ♦ Permanently increase your maximum Hit Points **or** Mind Points by 5 (your choice).

ACE OF CARDS SKILLS

DOUBLE OR NOTHING

Before you perform a Check, you may declare **double or nothing**. If you do, until the end of that Check, any dice you roll that show an **even** number are treated as if that number was **doubled**, and other dice you roll are treated as showing a **1**.

HIGH OR LOW

[+5]

When you resolve a set with **Magic Cards**, if it includes a **joker** and/or a **7**, you deal **[SL]** extra damage until the start of your next turn; if it includes a **joker** and/or a **1**, all damage you suffer is reduced by **[SL]** until the start of your next turn (before Affinities); if it doesn't include any **joker**, **1**, or **7**, you recover **[SL × 2]** Hit Points.

MAGIC CARDS

[+3]

You gain a **deck**, a **hand** and a **discard pile** (see next page).

During a conflict, you may use an action and spend up to **[10 + (SL × 5)]** Mind Points (minimum 10). If you do, discard and **resolve 1 card** from your **hand** for every 5 MP spent this way (to a maximum of 5 cards; these cards form a **set**). After you resolve the effect of the **set** (if any), draw that many cards.

MULLIGAN

[+2]

When you **hit** one or more enemies with an attack during your turn, you may discard up to **[SL + 1]** cards. If you do, draw that many cards.

TRAP CARD

[+2]

After an enemy you can see resolves an **Attack**, **Objective**, **Skill**, or **Spell** action, you may discard up to **(SL + 1)** cards that are **jokers** or whose **suit** corresponds to a damage type based on the enemy action: **ice (Attack)**, **fire (Objective)**, **earth (Skill)**, or **air (Spell)**. If you do, draw that many cards; then you may perform the **Spell** action for free, casting a spell with a total Mind Point cost equal to or lower than **(SL × 5)** (you must still pay its MP cost) and you cannot use this Skill again until the start of your next turn.

MANAGING THE DECK

Your **deck** is an actual deck of cards that you can assemble however you prefer, provided their backs are identical and you follow the restrictions below:

- ♦ The deck contains exactly **30 cards**: **2 jokers**, plus **28** cards divided into **4 types**, called **suits**; for instance, in a standard poker deck the **suits** are **clubs** (♣), **diamonds** (♦), **hearts** (♥), and **spades** (♠). When you create your character's **deck**, associate each **suit** to a different damage type among **air**, **earth**, **fire**, and **ice**.
- ♦ For each **suit**, the deck contains **7 cards** with **values 1 to 7**.

The simplest approach is to use a poker deck (removing **face cards** and **cards numbered 8 to 10**), but you can also use minor arcana from tarot, cards from collectible card games, and much more. Just make sure the combinations are easy to identify.

- ♦ When a **conflict** begins, shuffle all 30 cards in your **deck** and place it **face down** in front of yourself, then draw **5 cards** to form your starting **hand**.
- ♦ If you need to draw cards and your **deck** doesn't have enough, draw as many as you can, **shuffle your discard pile into the deck**, place it **face down**, then keep drawing.
- ♦ A When you draw cards, you draw them from your **deck** and add them to your **hand**. Normally only you can see your **hand**, but you can show it to others if you so wish.
- ♦ When you discard cards, you do so from your **hand** and place them **face up** into your **discard pile**, in whatever order you prefer. The order of cards in your **discard pile** cannot be modified, but anyone may look at them.

Your **deck**, your **hand**, and your **discard pile** (as well as any Skills and effects related to them) are only available during conflict scenes; at the end of each conflict, shuffle all 30 cards back into your **deck** and put it aside.

RESOLVING A SET

To produce a given effect, a **set** must match its requirements **exactly** (for instance, resolving a **set of 5 cards with the same value** will not match the requirements of **Jackpot**; it has to be composed of **exactly 4 cards**).

When you resolve a **set** that includes **jokers**, you choose their **suit** and **value (1 to 7)**.

If a **set** matches the requirements of two or more effects, you must choose and apply **only one** of those effects.

If you use a classic poker deck, the recommended suit types are: **air** (♦), **earth** (♣), **fire** (♥), and **ice** (♠).

EFFECT	SET REQUIREMENTS
<i>Note: effects Blinding Flush, Double Trouble, and Magic Flush deal 10 extra damage if you are level 20 or higher, or 20 extra damage if you are level 40 or higher.</i>	
Jackpot	4 cards of the same value, none of which is a joker
Any Player Character who has surrendered but is still narratively present on the scene regains consciousness (this does not cancel the effects of their Surrender); then, you and every ally you can see recover 777 Hit Points and 777 Mind Points.	
Magic Flush	4 cards of consecutive values and of the same suit
You deal damage equal to [25 + the total value of the resolved cards] to every enemy you can see. The type of this damage matches the suit of the resolved cards.	
Blinding Flush	4 cards of consecutive values
You deal damage equal to [15 + the total value of the resolved cards] to every enemy you can see. The type of this damage is light if the highest value among those cards is even , or dark if that value is odd .	
Full Status	3 cards of the same value + 2 cards of the same value
Choose two status effects among dazed , shaken , slow , and weak . If [the highest value among resolved cards] is even , you and every ally you can see recover from the chosen status effects; if odd , every enemy you can see suffers them.	
Triple Support	3 cards of the same value
You and every ally you can see recover an amount of Hit Points equal to [the total value of the resolved cards, multiplied by 3] .	
Double Trouble	2 cards of the same value + 2 cards of the same value
You deal damage equal to [10 + the highest value among resolved cards] to each of up to two different enemies you can see. The type of this damage is one of your choice among those matching the suits of the resolved cards.	
Magic Pair	2 cards of the same value
You perform a free attack with a weapon you have equipped. If this attack deals damage, choose a suit among those of the resolved cards; all damage dealt by the attack becomes of the type matching that suit .	

NEW HEROIC SKILLS

BLACK & WHITE

Requirements: you must have mastered one or more Classes among **Ace of Cards**, **Darkblade**, **Entropist**, and **Spiritist**.

When you resolve the **Double Trouble** effect, you may have all of its damage become **light** or **dark** (instead of being of a type matching the **suits** of the resolved cards).

Additionally, as long as there is a **joker** in your **discard pile**, all damage dealt by your **Blinding Flush**, **Double Trouble**, and **Magic Flush** effects ignores Immunities and Resistances.

CARD VANGUARD

Requirements: you must have mastered the **Ace of Cards** Class.

When you discard cards due to the **Magic Cards** Skill, you may choose 1 of them and place it face down in front of you as a **vanguard card** instead of putting it into your **discard pile**. You may only do so if you have **two or fewer vanguard cards** in play.

When a source deals damage to you and/or one or more allies you can see, you may reveal one of your **vanguard cards** in play. If you do and that card is a **joker** or its **suit** matches the damage type dealt by that source, you and every ally you can see gain Resistance to that damage type until the end of the current turn; then, put the revealed **vanguard card** on top of your **discard pile**, and it stops being a **vanguard card**.

You may look at your **vanguard cards** at any time. At the end of each conflict, if you have one or more **vanguard cards** in play, shuffle them back into your deck.

DUEL MASTER

Requirements: you must have mastered one or more Classes among **Ace of Cards**, **Fury**, **Rogue**, **Sharpshooter**, and **Weaponmaster**.

When you resolve the **Magic Pair** effect, if you attack with a weapon belonging to the **arcane**, **dagger**, **firearm**, **sword**, or **thrown** Category, you deal extra damage equal to **【the common value of the resolved cards】** and regain an amount of Mind Points equal to **【twice the common value of the resolved cards】**. For instance, resolving a pair of **5s** will allow you to deal 5 extra damage and regain 10 Mind Points.

FORBIDDEN RITE

Requirements: you must have mastered one or more Classes among **Ace of Cards** and **Arcanist**, and you must have acquired **3 Skill Levels** in the **Magic Cards** Skill.

After you discard cards due to the **Magic Cards** Skill, if at least one of those cards is a **joker**, you may choose any number of **non-joker** cards in your **discard pile** and shuffle them into your **deck**.

You also add the following **effect** to your list of **sets**:

EFFECT	SET REQUIREMENTS
Forbidden Monarch	4 cards of the same value , none of which is a joker + 1 joker

You deal damage 777 damage to every enemy you can see; the type of this damage is **light** if **[the common value of the 4 cards]** is **even**, or **dark** if that value is **odd**.

If there is a **joker** in your **discard pile**, the damage dealt by this effect ignores Immunities and Resistances.

SAMPLE CHARACTERS

COLLECTOR

Dexterity **d8**, Insight **d8**, Might **d6**, Willpower **d10**

Ace of Cards (3 levels): Magic Cards, Trap Card (SL 2)

Chimerist (1 level): Spell Mimic

Rogue (1 level): Soul Steal

Tome (described as a CCG album!), sage robe, 170 zenit.

TRICKSTER

Dexterity **d8**, Insight **d8**, Might **d8**, Willpower **d8**

Ace of Cards (2 levels): Double or Nothing, Magic Cards

Entropist (2 levels): Entropic Magic (Divination), Lucky Seven

Sharpshooter (1 level): Crossfire

Stacked deck (custom weapon, **[DEX + INS]**, **thrown**, **ranged**, **accurate**, **improved magic defense**, **powerful**), sage robe, 70 zenit.